

# JAI WOODS

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## EDUCATION

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**University of California, Santa Barbara**  
B.A Economics and Geography (GIS) *GPA: 3.5*

Santa Barbara, CA  
September 2022 - June 2026

## EXPERIENCE

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**University of Iowa Physics and Astronomy Department**  
*Edge of Space Program*

Iowa City, Iowa  
July 2025 - August 2025

- 3D printed plastic housing for DJI Matrice 300 RTK drone sensor payload
- Soldered and assembled electronic components including the battery, button, breadboard, Raspberry Pi, camera, and LiDAR sensor together to be placed inside 3D printed enclosure
- Launched 6 drone flights over Ashton Prairie, comparing vegetation height in the unrestored and restored regions of the survey area, collecting LiDAR point data and RGB imagery
- Presented our findings on plant height data at a symposium, communicating how restoration efforts by the University of Iowa have contributed to healthier, taller and more biodiverse vegetation

**The Nature Conservancy**  
*Bren Environmental Leadership (BEL) Program*

Santa Barbara, CA  
June 2024 - September 2024

- Spearheaded the creation of a comprehensive user guide for a deep-learning satellite whale-detection tool
- Collaborated with conservationists at NOAA to protect whale populations through satellite detection
- Gained extensive experience in machine-learning techniques, especially convolutional neural networks
- Developed expertise in applied remote-sensing technologies for whale-conservation management

**Freelance Tradesman**  
*Part time landscaping and construction work*

Sonoma County, CA  
May 2017 - August 2023

- Provided skilled construction and landscaping services to multiple clients
- Managed small-scale projects independently, developing competencies in budgeting, scheduling, and client communication
- Contributed to dozens of residential improvement projects by applying strong organizational and technical abilities
- Utilized design and planning software to support efficient project visualization and execution

## POSITIONS

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**Geography Club Co-President**

Organize, plan and manage geography club events, coordinate with the board, and handle administrative duties + outreach

**Isla Vista Housing Co-op Treasurer**

Manage \$21,000+ in monthly rental revenue for the student housing co-op, ensuring timely payments, and accounting for charges

## SKILLS AND CERTIFICATES

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**Working Towards Part 107 Certified Remote Pilot License**

Statistics, data science, and computer science coursework (Regression, LLMs, software design)

Geographic information systems and remote sensing coursework (suitability analysis, network analysis, LiDAR data management, classification techniques)

Intermediate level in programming languages: C, C++, C#, Python, R

Proficiency in ESRI Suite (ArcGIS Pro, Online), ENVI Remote Sensing, Google Earth Engine

Strong written and oral communication skills

Skilled user of Microsoft Office (Word, PowerPoint, Excel) and Google Suite (Docs, Sheets)

Comprehensive knowledge of accounting, banking, and finance

Advanced quantitative economics coursework (Econometrics, Micro and Macro theory)

Social media content creation: photography, videography, and graphic design skills